

In Rohit Sharma's 100, a message for fans

In a **matter of** a month, India captain Rohit Sharma experienced the **contrasting** emotions and extreme reactions of the **famously fickle** Indian fan. At the start of the year, because of weak Test-match form, he **stepped aside** as captain for the final Test of the series against Australia. There were questions about the 37-year-old's place in the ODI team too. The rock of the team not too long ago, he was now seen as a **roadblock** for youngsters waiting in the **wings**. That's when he scored a **sparkling** ODI hundred — a 90-ball 119 with seven sixes against England at Cuttack. Overnight, Rohit was **back on the pedestal**. In this **volte-face** is a lesson for **die-hards** following cricket. Show patience before passing **verdicts** on the game's greats or **hying** the young.

Sports **fandom** offers the pleasures of **tribalism**. It is easy to get carried away while being part of a **passionate** crowd. But the **supercharged mob** environment forces **misjudgments** that hurt the game and its stars. Over the years, the **kangaroo court** has moved from the stadium to social media, where agents and fan clubs **pit** one superstar **against** another. Rohitans never miss a chance to **undermine** Virat Kohli and the Viratians wait for their chance to hit back. Unlike any time in the past, this toxic fan culture has created a **bitterness** that **threatens** to **spill** onto the field and dressing room, too. **Wrong calls** that can **hamper** Indian cricket **in the long run** **can be taken** because of outside pressure.



Back in 2010, when Indian batting great Rahul Dravid was out of form and fans wanted him out, he received **unsolicited** advice from Australia captain Ricky Ponting. Ignore the **critics**, just score runs like you have always done, he said. Dravid did take a U-turn and had his best England tour ever after that. **Stalwarts** of the game **are** **conscious** of their image and **legacy**. They also know who to listen to and when to go.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Take a call** (phrase) – Take a decision निर्णय लेना

Vocabulary

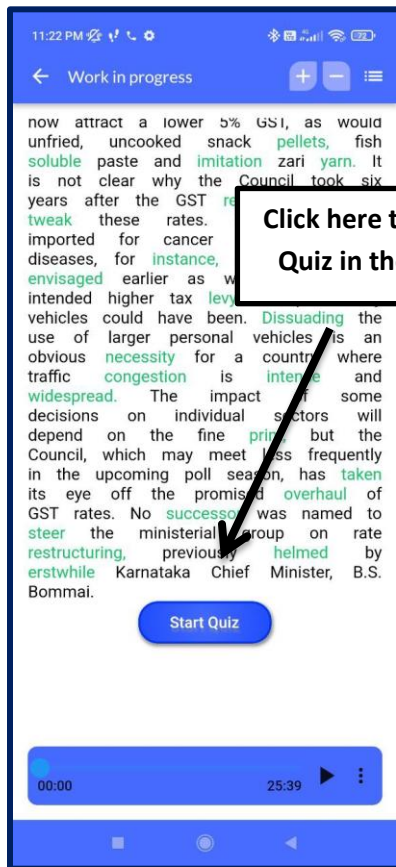
1. **In a matter of something** (phrase) – Within a short period of time. कुछ ही समय में
2. **Contrasting** (adjective) – Different, Opposing, Divergent, Distinct, Contrary विरोधाभासी
3. **Famously** (adverb) – Notably, Renowned, Celebrated, Well-known, Prominently प्रसिद्ध रूप से
4. **Fickle** (adjective) – Unpredictable, Changeable, Inconstant, Volatile, Erratic अस्थिर
5. **Step aside** (phrasal verb) – To withdraw or make way for someone else. पीछे हटना
6. **Roadblock** (noun) – Obstacle, Barrier, Hindrance, Impediment, Blockage रुकावट
7. **Wing** (noun) – Faction, division, group, arm, branch. शाखा
8. **Sparkling** (adjective) – Brilliant, Shining, Glittering, Radiant, Dazzling चमकदार
9. **Back on the pedestal** (phrase) – Restored to a position of respect or admiration. सम्मान की स्थिति में वापस
10. **Volte-face** (noun) – Reversal, U-turn, Turnaround, Change, Shift पलटवार
11. **Die-hard** (noun) – Devotee, Fanatic, Loyalist, Enthusiast, Admirer कट्टर समर्थक
12. **Verdict** (noun) – Judgment, Decision, Conclusion, Opinion, Ruling फैसला
13. **Hype** (verb) – Promote, Publicize, Advertise, Exaggerate, Boost प्रचार करना
14. **Fandom** (noun) – Fanbase, Followers, Supporters, Admirers, Enthusiasts प्रशंसक समूह
15. **Tribalism** (noun) – Partisanship, Sectarianism, Factionalism, Clannishness, Loyalty जनजातीयता
16. **Passionate** (adjective) – Emotional, Intense, Fervent, Ardent, Zealous उत्साही
17. **Supercharged** (adjective) – Intense, Energized, Amplified, Heightened, Boosted अत्यधिक उत्तेजित
18. **Mob** (noun) – Crowd, Throng, Mass, Horde, Gathering भीड़
19. **Misjudgement** (noun) – Mistake, Error, Blunder, Misstep, Miscalculation गलत निर्णय
20. **Kangaroo court** (phrase) – An unofficial court with biased or unfair judgments. अनौपचारिक अदालत
21. **Pit against** (phrasal verb) – To set someone in competition or conflict with another. मुकाबला कराना

22. **Undermine** (verb) – Weaken, Sabotage, Subvert, Erode, Diminish कमजोर करना
23. **Bitterness** (noun) – Resentment, Hostility, Animosity, Rancor, Sourness कटुता
24. **Threaten** (verb) – Endanger, Menace, Intimidate, Imperil, Jeopardize धमकी देना
25. **Spill** (verb) – Overflow, Spread, Scatter, Pour, Disclose फैलना
26. **Hamper** (verb) – Hinder, Obstruct, Impede, Restrict, Block बाधा डालना
27. **In the long run** (phrase) – Over a long period of time; eventually. लंबे समय में
28. **Unsolicited** (adjective) – Unrequested, Uninvited, Unasked, Unwanted, Spontaneous अनचाहा
29. **Critics** (noun) – Reviewers, Commentators, Analysts, Judges, Evaluators आलोचक
30. **Stalwart** (noun) – Pillar, Supporter, Champion, Defender, Mainstay स्तंभ
31. **Conscious** (of) (adjective) – Aware, Mindful, Sensitive, Alert, Attentive सचेत
32. **Legacy** (noun) – Heritage, Inheritance, Tradition, Bequest, Impact विरासत

Summary of the Editorial

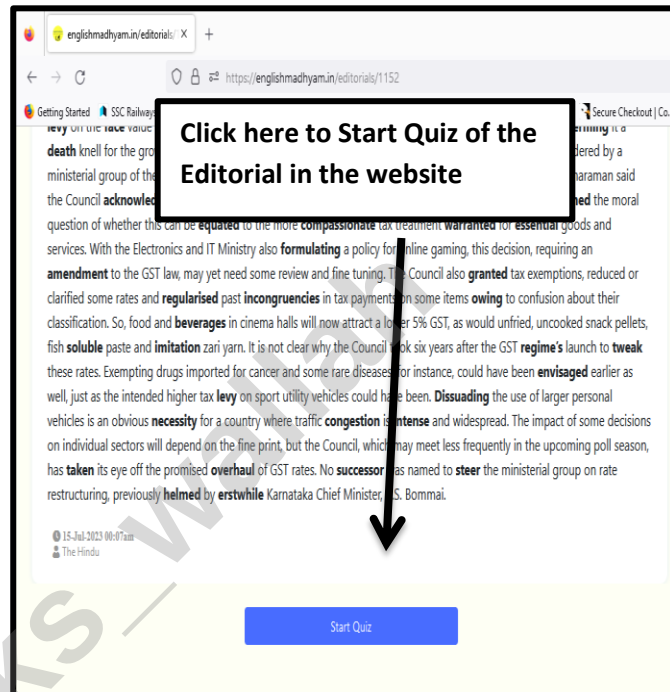
1. **Rohit Sharma's Comeback:** Rohit Sharma faced criticism for his Test form and ODI future but silenced critics with a stunning 90-ball 119 against England in Cuttack.
2. **Fickle Fan Reactions:** Indian fans quickly shifted from questioning Rohit's place in the team to celebrating his return to form.
3. **Lesson for Fans:** The episode highlights the need for patience before judging cricket legends or overhyping young players.
4. **Tribalism in Sports:** Sports fandom often leads to passionate but irrational judgments, fueled by mob mentality.
5. **Social Media Toxicity:** Fan wars on social media, like Rohit vs. Kohli fan clubs, create a toxic environment that can harm the game and players.
6. **Impact on Players:** The pressure from fan-driven narratives can affect players' performances and team dynamics.
7. **Historical Parallel:** Rahul Dravid faced similar criticism in 2010 but made a strong comeback after ignoring external noise.
8. **Ricky Ponting's Advice:** Ponting advised Dravid to focus on his game and ignore critics, which helped him excel during the England tour.
9. **Legacy Awareness:** Veteran players like Rohit and Dravid are conscious of their legacy and know when to tune out distractions.
10. **Fan Responsibility:** Fans should avoid knee-jerk reactions and support players through ups and downs to foster a healthier sports culture.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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